

ACRME — Epic / Story / Task Backlog

Azure Capacity Reservation Management Engine (ACRME)

Generated 2026-08-22 from the Production-Readiness Review & Final Architecture (PRR).

Single source of truth: backlog_data.py. This Markdown and the Jira import CSV are both generated from it, so they never drift.

1. Backlog Summary

Metric	Value
Epics	19
Stories	66
Tasks	175
Total story points	426

Points & stories by delivery phase

Phase	Meaning	Stories	Story points
P1	Pilot — foundation, manual-assist, single/few regions	55	350
P2	Controlled automation — scoring, sharing, quota, multi-region	11	76

2. Legend & Conventions

- **ID scheme** — Epics ACRME-E##, Stories ACRME-S####, Tasks ACRME-T#####.
- **Priority** — Highest / High / Medium / Low (Jira default names).
- **Points** — Fibonacci story points (1, 2, 3, 5, 8, 13).
- **Phase** — P1 Pilot · P2 Controlled automation · P3 Production/Future.
- **PRR refs** — sections of the Production-Readiness Review & Architecture that drive the item.
- **Depends on** — upstream stories that must land first.

3. Epic Index

Epic	Name	Stories	Points
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Epic	Name	Stories	Points
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4. Epics, Stories & Tasks

ACRME-E01 — Foundation & Platform Infrastructure

Goal. Stand up the buildable core: CQRS command/query separation, saga orchestration, the command/event bus, the authoritative engine state store, and provider-isolated Azure adapters.

PRR references. §23 Logical Component Architecture, §24 MG & Subscription Topology, §38 WAF

Rollup. 5 stories · 39 points

Story	Title	Priority	Points	Phase	Depends on
ACRME-S0101	CQRS Command and Query API skeleton behind API gateway	Highest	8	P1	—
ACRME-S0102	Saga orchestrator and command/event bus	Highest	13	P1	ACRME-S0101
ACRME-S0103	Authoritative engine state store and regional snapshot store	Highest	8	P1	ACRME-S0101
ACRME-S0104	Provider-isolated Azure Resource Manager adapters	High	5	P1	ACRME-S0102
ACRME-S0105	Management-group and subscription topology bootstrap	High	5	P1	—

ACRME-S0101 — CQRS Command and Query API skeleton behind API gateway

As a platform engineer, **I want** a Command API and a Query API fronted by an API gateway, **so that** state-changing and read operations are cleanly separated and independently scalable.

- **Priority:** Highest · **Points:** 8 · **Phase:** P1
- **PRR refs:** §23, §35

- **Depends on:** —

Acceptance criteria

- Command API and Query API are deployed as separate services behind the API gateway.
- All mutations route only through the Command API; all reads only through the Query API.
- Health/readiness probes return 200 for both services.
- Requests are traced end-to-end with a correlation ID.

Tasks

- ☐ ACRME-T010101 Scaffold Command API service (routing, DI, config, health probes)
- ☐ ACRME-T010102 Scaffold Query API service (routing, DI, config, health probes)
- ☐ ACRME-T010103 Configure API gateway routes, request size limits, and correlation-ID propagation
- ☐ ACRME-T010104 Add structured logging and distributed tracing baseline

ACRME-S0102 — Saga orchestrator and command/event bus

As a platform engineer, **I want** a persisted saga orchestrator driving operation workers over a command/event bus, **so that** multi-step Azure operations run reliably with checkpoints and compensation.

- **Priority:** Highest · **Points:** 13 · **Phase:** P1
- **PRR refs:** §23, §38 Reliability
- **Depends on:** ACRME-S0101

Acceptance criteria

- Sagas persist each step with a checkpoint and support compensation on failure (closes R-26).
- Operation workers consume commands from the bus and publish events idempotently.
- A partially failed saga can be resumed or compensated without duplicate side effects.
- Saga state is queryable via the operation resource.

Tasks

- ☐ ACRME-T010201 Implement persisted saga state machine with checkpointing
- ☐ ACRME-T010202 Implement command/event bus abstraction and worker pool
- ☐ ACRME-T010203 Implement compensation handlers and partial-saga recovery
- ☐ ACRME-T010204 Add idempotent event publication and de-duplication

ACRME-S0103 — Authoritative engine state store and regional snapshot store

As a platform engineer, **I want** an authoritative engine-intent store plus a regional snapshot store, **so that** engine intent and cached Azure state are separated with clear ownership.

- **Priority:** Highest · **Points:** 8 · **Phase:** P1
- **PRR refs:** §23, §34, R-33
- **Depends on:** ACRME-S0101

Acceptance criteria

- Engine state store is authoritative for engine intent; Azure RPs remain authoritative for Azure state.
- Regional snapshot store holds versioned snapshots consumed by placement.
- Throughput is load-tested and autoscale target documented (closes R-33).
- Optimistic concurrency (state version) is enforced on writes.

Tasks

- ☐ ACRME-T010301 Model and provision the authoritative state store with versioning
- ☐ ACRME-T010302 Model and provision the versioned regional snapshot store
- ☐ ACRME-T010303 Load-test throughput and set autoscale targets (R-33)

ACRME-S0104 — Provider-isolated Azure Resource Manager adapters

As a platform engineer, **I want** Azure API adapters isolated per resource provider behind a stable interface, **so that** preview APIs can be flag-gated and swapped without touching business logic.

- **Priority:** High · **Points:** 5 · **Phase:** P1
- **PRR refs:** §23, §21, R-01
- **Depends on:** ACRME-S0102

Acceptance criteria

- Compute, Reservations, Quota, and Resource Graph adapters sit behind stable interfaces.
- Each adapter records API version used per call for evidence.
- Adapters are individually mockable for unit tests.

Tasks

- ☐ ACRME-T010401 Define adapter interfaces per resource provider
- ☐ ACRME-T010402 Implement Compute/Reservations/Quota/ARG adapters with API-version capture
- ☐ ACRME-T010403 Add adapter-level mocks and contract fixtures

ACRME-S0105 — Management-group and subscription topology bootstrap

As a platform operator, **I want** the platform/customer MG and provider/consumer subscription topology provisioned as code, **so that** the engine UAMI and CRGs live in a governed, repeatable hierarchy.

- **Priority:** High · **Points:** 5 · **Phase:** P1
- **PRR refs:** §24
- **Depends on:** —

Acceptance criteria

- Platform MG (provider + engine subs) and customer MG (prod/nonprod/dr subs) provisioned via IaC.
- Engine UAMI created in the engine subscription and referenced by downstream role assignments.
- Topology is parameterised so a customer need not share one hierarchy.

Tasks

- ☐ ACRME-T010501 Author IaC for management-group and subscription topology
- ☐ ACRME-T010502 Provision engine User-Assigned Managed Identity
- ☐ ACRME-T010503 Parameterise topology for per-customer variation

ACRME-E02 — Subscription & Onboarding Lifecycle

Goal. Onboard and offboard customer subscriptions with provider/consumer authorization validation, location-separation enforcement, and full read-back before a customer is marked ready.

PRR references. §22 Must, §26, §43 Onboarding, Runbook B

Rollup. 4 stories · 34 points

Story	Title	Priority	Points	Phase	Depends on
ACRME-S0201	Subscription onboarding workflow with prerequisite gates	Highest	13	P1	ACRME-S0102

Story	Title	Priority	Points	Phase	Depends on
ACRME-S0202	Provider and consumer authorization validation	Highest	8	P1	ACRME-S0201
ACRME-S0203	Location separation enforcement (hard constraint) at onboarding	Highest	5	P1	ACRME-S0201
ACRME-S0204	Subscription lifecycle monitoring and offboarding	High	8	P1	ACRME-S0202

ACRME-S0201 — Subscription onboarding workflow with prerequisite gates

As a operations engineer, **I want** a gated onboarding workflow that collects inputs and validates every prerequisite, **so that** no customer reaches shared capacity until all checks pass and are recorded.

- **Priority:** Highest · **Points:** 13 · **Phase:** P1
- **PRR refs:** §43 Onboarding, §22 Must
- **Depends on:** ACRME-S0102

Acceptance criteria

- Onboarding collects account details, environments, SKUs/regions, recovery objectives, and consent.
- Workflow blocks progression until zone map, sharing read-back, quota, and DR-floor checks pass.
- Customer marked ready only after all confirmation gates succeed.
- Every gate result is persisted to the audit trail.

Tasks

- ☐ ACRME-T020101 Model ManagedSubscription entity and onboarding state machine
- ☐ ACRME-T020102 Implement input-collection and consent capture step
- ☐ ACRME-T020103 Wire prerequisite gates (zone, sharing, quota, DR floor) as blocking checks
- ☐ ACRME-T020104 Implement 'ready' marking with full read-back confirmation

ACRME-S0202 — Provider and consumer authorization validation

As a security-conscious operator, **I want** provider registration and consumer deployment rights validated during onboarding, **so that** sharing and deployment cannot proceed on an unauthorized subscription.

- **Priority:** Highest · **Points:** 8 · **Phase:** P1
- **PRR refs:** §25, §22 Must
- **Depends on:** ACRME-S0201

Acceptance criteria

- Provider subscription and RP registration validated before any sharing action.
- Consumer deployment identity rights on the target CRG validated and read back.
- Validation failure blocks onboarding with a structured precondition error.

Tasks

- ☐ ACRME-T020201 Validate provider subscription + resource provider registration
- ☐ ACRME-T020202 Validate consumer deployment identity rights on CRG scope
- ☐ ACRME-T020203 Emit structured precondition failures on authorization gaps

ACRME-S0203 — Location separation enforcement (hard constraint) at onboarding

As a capacity architect, **I want** onboarding to reject layouts where Prod/NonProd/DR are not correctly separated, **so that** a single regional event cannot take out incompatible environments.

- **Priority:** Highest · **Points:** 5 · **Phase:** P1
- **PRR refs:** §43 Onboarding, HC separation
- **Depends on:** ACRME-S0201

Acceptance criteria

- Prod and DR in the same location is rejected; Prod and NonProd in the same location is rejected.
- NonProd co-located with DR is allowed only with recorded policy + customer acceptance.
- Rejection reason is explicit and audited.

Tasks

- ☐ ACRME-T020301 Implement separation-rule validator for environment layout
- ☐ ACRME-T020302 Add NonProd/DR co-location policy exception with acceptance capture

ACRME-S0204 — Subscription lifecycle monitoring and offboarding

As a operations engineer, **I want** lifecycle monitoring plus a controlled offboarding checklist, **so that** suspension/transfer and offboarding never strand running VM restarts.

- **Priority:** High · **Points:** 8 · **Phase:** P1
- **PRR refs:** Runbook B, R-10, R-28
- **Depends on:** ACRME-S0202

Acceptance criteria

- Subscription suspension/transfer triggers revalidation and an alert (closes R-28).
- Offboarding checks active associations before removing sharing (closes R-10).
- Offboarding defaults to deny when active associations exist.

Tasks

- ☐ ACRME-T020401 Implement subscription lifecycle monitor + revalidation (R-28)
- ☐ ACRME-T020402 Implement offboarding checklist with association pre-checks (R-10)

ACRME-E03 — CRG & Capacity Reservation Management

Goal. Inventory, create, and safely mutate Capacity Reservation Groups and Capacity Reservations modeled by SKU and zone, with guarded quantity changes and no unsafe auto-decrease in Phase 1.

PRR references. §25, §30, §5 CR quantity update

Rollup. 3 stories · 21 points

Story	Title	Priority	Points	Phase	Depends on
ACRME-S0301	CRG and CR inventory by SKU and zone	Highest	8	P1	ACRME-S0104
ACRME-S0302	Guarded CR quantity increase	High	8	P1	ACRME-S0301, ACRME-S0902

Story	Title	Priority	Points	Phase	Depends on
ACRME-S0303	Guarded CR reduction with zero-reduction and running-VM safety	High	5	P1	ACRME-S0301

ACRME-S0301 — CRG and CR inventory by SKU and zone

As a capacity operator, **I want** authoritative inventory of CRGs and CRs modeled per SKU and zone, **so that** placement and scaling decisions run on accurate capacity state.

- **Priority:** Highest · **Points:** 8 · **Phase:** P1
- **PRR refs:** §25, §34
- **Depends on:** ACRME-S0104

Acceptance criteria

- CRG hierarchy (Prod/NonProd/DR per region) inventoried with CRs by SKU and zone.
- Provider-side inventory is authoritative; ARG used only for diagnostics (R-03).
- Inventory refresh confirms against ARM before use for mutation (R-04).

Tasks

- ☐ ACRME-T030101 Model CapacityReservationGroup and CapacityReservation entities
- ☐ ACRME-T030102 Implement inventory sync with SKU/zone dimensioning
- ☐ ACRME-T030103 Mark provider inventory authoritative; ARG diagnostics-only (R-03/R-04)

ACRME-S0302 — Guarded CR quantity increase

As a capacity operator, **I want** approval-gated CR quantity increases via tracked operations, **so that** capacity grows safely without cost or capacity surprises.

- **Priority:** High · **Points:** 8 · **Phase:** P1
- **PRR refs:** §30, R-15, G-24
- **Depends on:** ACRME-S0301, ACRME-S0902

Acceptance criteria

- CapacityIncreaseRequest entity with lifecycle, approval, retry, and cancellation (closes G-24).
- Increase requires operator approval and enforces a policy maximum delta (R-15).
- Quantity updated only after validated quota; actual quantity confirmed after change.

Tasks

- ☐ ACRME-T030201 Model CapacityIncreaseRequest entity + lifecycle (G-24)
- ☐ ACRME-T030202 Implement approval gate and max-delta guard (R-15)
- ☐ ACRME-T030203 Implement quota-validated update with post-change confirmation
- ☐ ACRME-T030204 Add retry and cancellation handling to the request lifecycle

ACRME-S0303 — Guarded CR reduction with zero-reduction and running-VM safety

As a capacity operator, **I want** CR reduction blocked for unknown/destructive scenarios, **so that** reductions never silently remove capacity relied on by running VMs.

- **Priority:** High · **Points:** 5 · **Phase:** P1
- **PRR refs:** §5 CR quantity update, R-09
- **Depends on:** ACRME-S0301

Acceptance criteria

- Reduction below allocated/running usage is blocked with a scenario matrix (R-09).
- Zero-size and unknown-behavior scenarios are blocked pending POC evidence.
- Auto-decrease is disabled in Phase 1.

Tasks

- ☐ ACRME-T030301 Implement reduction floor validator against allocation/running usage
- ☐ ACRME-T030302 Encode CR reduction scenario matrix and block unknowns (R-09)

ACRME-E04 — CRG Sharing & Consumer Authorization

Goal. Explicit, read-back-verified CRG sharing across subscriptions with the 100-consumer ceiling handled by sharding, plus safe and forced unsharing.

PRR references. §25 Sharing, §5 CRG sharing, Runbook B, R-02

Rollup. 4 stories · 21 points

Story	Title	Priority	Points	Phase	Depends on
ACRME-S0401	Explicit CRG sharing workflow with full read-back	Highest	8	P1	ACRME-S0202
ACRME-S0402	100-consumer ceiling monitoring and CRG sharding	High	5	P1	ACRME-S0401
ACRME-S0403	Safe and forced unsharing with restart-hazard protection	High	5	P1	ACRME-S0401
ACRME-S0404	Sharing drift detection	High	3	P1	ACRME-S0401

ACRME-S0401 — Explicit CRG sharing workflow with full read-back

As a sharing operator, **I want** a sharing sequence that validates, adds, grants, and reads back every step, **so that** a relationship is only 'active' after confirmed state.

- **Priority:** Highest · **Points:** 8 · **Phase:** P1
- **PRR refs:** §25 Sharing sequence
- **Depends on:** ACRME-S0202

Acceptance criteria

- Sharing adds only explicitly named consumer subscriptions (never tenant-wide).
- Sharing profile and role state are read back and recorded before returning success.
- SharingRelationship entity persisted with active status.

Tasks

- ☐ ACRME-T040101 Model SharingRelationship entity
- ☐ ACRME-T040102 Implement validate->add->grant->readback sharing saga
- ☐ ACRME-T040103 Persist confirmed relationship and expose via Query API

ACRME-S0402 — 100-consumer ceiling monitoring and CRG sharding

As a capacity architect, **I want** continuous relationship-count monitoring and a sharding path, **so that** the pool never silently breaches the 100-consumer platform limit.

- **Priority:** High · **Points:** 5 · **Phase:** P1
- **PRR refs:** R-02, §5 CRG sharing
- **Depends on:** ACRME-S0401

Acceptance criteria

- Relationship count monitored continuously, not only at create time (R-02).
- Approaching-limit alert fires before the ceiling is hit.
- Documented sharding procedure splits a pool without downtime.

Tasks

- ☐ ACRME-T040201 Implement consumer-count monitor and threshold alert (R-02)
- ☐ ACRME-T040202 Document and script CRG sharding procedure

ACRME-S0403 — Safe and forced unsharing with restart-hazard protection

As a sharing operator, **I want** unsharing to default-deny when active associations exist, **so that** removing sharing never strands VM restarts.

- **Priority:** High · **Points:** 5 · **Phase:** P1
- **PRR refs:** Runbook B, R-10
- **Depends on:** ACRME-S0401

Acceptance criteria

- Forced unsharing rejects by default when active associations exist (Runbook B).
- Consumer owner approval captured before any forced action; impact record retained.
- ForcedUnsharingRequested alert fires on active associations.

Tasks

- ☐ ACRME-T040301 Implement association enumeration + default-deny gate
- ☐ ACRME-T040302 Implement approval capture, read-back, and impact record

ACRME-S0404 — Sharing drift detection

As a SRE, **I want** detection when desired and actual sharing profiles differ, **so that** unauthorized or missing consumers are surfaced immediately.

- **Priority:** High · **Points:** 3 · **Phase:** P1
- **PRR refs:** §37 Alerts, R-03
- **Depends on:** ACRME-S0401

Acceptance criteria

- SharingDrift alert on desired/actual mismatch; UnauthorizedConsumer alert on unapproved subscription.
- Drift check runs on the adaptive reconciliation cadence.

Tasks

- ☐ ACRME-T040401 Implement desired-vs-actual sharing comparator
- ☐ ACRME-T040402 Wire SharingDrift and UnauthorizedConsumer alerts

ACRME-E05 — Quota Group Management

Goal. Two-group-per-region quota model (Prod group; shared NonProd+DR group) with provider/consumer/group validation and Preview groupType handling.

PRR references. §26, §5 Quota Groups, FC-11, R-05, R-06, R-43
Rollup. 4 stories · 21 points

Story	Title	Priority	Points	Phase	Depends on
ACRME-S0501	Two-group-per-region quota model	Highest	8	P1	ACRME-S0104
ACRME-S0502	Provider, consumer, and group quota validation	Highest	5	P1	ACRME-S0501
ACRME-S0503	Quota increase endpoint with propagation handling	High	5	P1	ACRME-S0502
ACRME-S0504	Quota Group groupType Preview status handling (FC-11 / R-43)	Medium	3	P1	ACRME-S0501

ACRME-S0501 — Two-group-per-region quota model

As a quota owner, **I want** a Prod quota group and a shared NonProd+DR quota group per region, **so that** budgets are governed separately without DR starving on NonProd demand.

- **Priority:** Highest · **Points:** 8 · **Phase:** P1
- **PRR refs:** §26
- **Depends on:** ACRME-S0104

Acceptance criteria

- QuotaGroup entities model Prod and shared NonProd+DR groups per region.
- Group formulas and exact controls implemented per §26.
- Membership never treated as proof a specific subscription can deploy (R-06).

Tasks

- ☐ ACRME-T050101 Model QuotaGroup and SubscriptionQuotaRecord entities
- ☐ ACRME-T050102 Implement two-group-per-region provisioning + formulas
- ☐ ACRME-T050103 Enforce mandatory subscription-level checks (R-06)

ACRME-S0502 — Provider, consumer, and group quota validation

As a quota owner, **I want** independent validation of provider, consumer, and group quota, **so that** placement never assumes quota it does not have.

- **Priority:** Highest · **Points:** 5 · **Phase:** P1
- **PRR refs:** §5, R-39
- **Depends on:** ACRME-S0501

Acceptance criteria

- Provider quota not double-counted; API semantics validated (R-39).
- Consumer and group quota validated independently before commit.

- QuotaStateUnknown alert on unavailable/stale reads.

Tasks

- ☐ ACRME-T050201 Implement provider/consumer/group quota validators
- ☐ ACRME-T050202 Validate quota API semantics to avoid double count (R-39)
- ☐ ACRME-T050203 Wire QuotaStateUnknown alert

ACRME-S0503 — Quota increase endpoint with propagation handling

As a quota owner, **I want** a tracked quota-increase submission that polls for confirmed state, **so that** the engine never assumes a propagation SLA.

- **Priority:** High · **Points:** 5 · **Phase:** P1
- **PRR refs:** §30, B-6, R-08
- **Depends on:** ACRME-S0502

Acceptance criteria

- Quota action submitted only when validated as required; polled to confirmed state (B-6).
- Observed propagation distribution recorded; timeout + manual path in runbook.

Tasks

- ☐ ACRME-T050301 Implement quota-increase submission + async polling
- ☐ ACRME-T050302 Record propagation distribution; add timeout/manual path (B-6)

ACRME-S0504 — Quota Group groupType Preview status handling (FC-11 / R-43)

As a quota owner, **I want** enforced-vs-advisory groupType treated as a Preview dependency, **so that** the engine never silently relies on preview-only enforcement semantics.

- **Priority:** Medium · **Points:** 3 · **Phase:** P1
- **PRR refs:** FC-11, R-43
- **Depends on:** ACRME-S0501

Acceptance criteria

- groupType enforcement semantics gated behind a Preview feature flag (FC-11).
- POC-30 confirms required API version; governance acceptance recorded if needed (R-43).

Tasks

- ☐ ACRME-T050401 Flag-gate groupType enforcement reliance (FC-11)
- ☐ ACRME-T050402 Confirm required API version via POC-30 and record acceptance

ACRME-E06 — Cross-Subscription Zone Alignment

Goal. Build and apply per-subscription physical-to-logical zone mapping so shared reservations land in the correct physical zone; reject on missing mapping.

PRR references. §5 FC-06, §42 POC 6a, R-11, R-41

Rollup. 2 stories · 13 points

Story	Title	Priority	Points	Phase	Depends on
ACRME-S0601	Zone mapping table built and verified at onboarding	Highest	8	P1	ACRME-S0104

Story	Title	Priority	Points	Phase	Depends on
ACRME-S0602	Zone translation applied before every consumer deployment	Highest	5	P1	ACRME-S0601

ACRME-S0601 — Zone mapping table built and verified at onboarding

As a placement owner, **I want** a physical-to-logical zone map per subscription and region built at onboarding, **so that** shared reservations align to the correct physical zone across accounts.

- **Priority:** Highest · **Points:** 8 · **Phase:** P1
- **PRR refs:** FC-06, R-41
- **Depends on:** ACRME-S0104

Acceptance criteria

- availabilityZoneMappings read for provider and consumer subscriptions for all managed regions.
- ZoneMappingRecord persisted per subscription/region and read back (FC-06).
- Onboarding blocks if the map cannot be built and verified.

Tasks

- ☐ ACRME-T060101 Model ZoneMappingRecord entity
- ☐ ACRME-T060102 Implement Subscriptions-List-Locations zone-mapping fetch
- ☐ ACRME-T060103 Persist + read-back mapping; block onboarding on failure

ACRME-S0602 — Zone translation applied before every consumer deployment

As a placement engine, **I want** zone translation applied before every zonal deployment, rejecting on missing mapping, **so that** a logical/physical mismatch never causes a silent deployment failure.

- **Priority:** Highest · **Points:** 5 · **Phase:** P1
- **PRR refs:** R-41, POC 6a
- **Depends on:** ACRME-S0601

Acceptance criteria

- Translation resolves the correct consumer logical zone for a provider physical zone.
- Deployment rejected with ZoneMappingUnavailable when mapping is absent (R-41).
- Targeted refresh on churn keeps mapping current (R-11).

Tasks

- ☐ ACRME-T060201 Implement zone-translation algorithm (physical<->logical)
- ☐ ACRME-T060202 Enforce ZoneMappingUnavailable rejection path (R-41)
- ☐ ACRME-T060203 Add event-triggered targeted mapping refresh (R-11)

ACRME-E07 — Region Selection & Placement Engine

Goal. Production-ready region selection: classification model, two-stage eligibility filter, Scenario 1/2 input modes, Middle East cross-geo extension, and the restricted-region exception workflow.

PRR references. \$27, \$43 Region selection, HC-1..HC-10, VR-1..VR-11

Rollup. 8 stories · 49 points

Story	Title	Priority	Points	Phase	Depends on
ACRME-S0701	Region classification model (Standard / Restricted / Cross-Geo Extension)	Highest	8	P1	ACRME-S0103
ACRME-S0702	Two-stage eligibility decision tree (HC-1..HC-10)	Highest	8	P1	ACRME-S0701
ACRME-S0703	Scenario 1 — geography-based Prod region derivation	Highest	8	P1	ACRME-S0702, ACRME-S0801
ACRME-S0704	Scenario 2 — specific region input validation	Highest	5	P1	ACRME-S0702
ACRME-S0705	Sequential CVAL then DR selection from Prod anchor	Highest	5	P1	ACRME-S0703, ACRME-S0704
ACRME-S0706	Middle East cross-geo extension (Saudi Arabia/UAE North → Belgium Central)	High	5	P1	ACRME-S0705
ACRME-S0707	Exception-based placement workflow for Restricted regions (EC-1..EC-4)	High	5	P1	ACRME-S0704
ACRME-S0708	Validation Rule Framework (VR-1..VR-11) and governance controls	Medium	5	P1	ACRME-S0701

ACRME-S0701 — Region classification model (Standard / Restricted / Cross-Geo Extension)

As a placement owner, **I want** every managed region classified and Restricted regions pre-filtered before scoring, **so that** constrained regions never enter automated placement.

- **Priority:** Highest · **Points:** 8 · **Phase:** P1
- **PRR refs:** §27 Classification

- **Depends on:** ACRME-S0103

Acceptance criteria

- Standard, Restricted, and Cross-Geo Extension classes encoded in PlacementPolicy.
- Restricted regions excluded as a pre-filter ahead of all hard constraints (HC-9).
- Unknown region rejected (VR-1); Restricted excluded from scoring (VR-2).

Tasks

- ☐ ACRME-T070101 Model region classification in PolicyVersion/PlacementPolicy
- ☐ ACRME-T070102 Implement Stage 1 classification pre-filter (HC-9)
- ☐ ACRME-T070103 Implement VR-1/VR-2 validation rules

ACRME-S0702 — Two-stage eligibility decision tree (HC-1..HC-10)

As a placement engine, **I want** surviving candidates evaluated against hard constraints HC-1..HC-10 before scoring, **so that** only fully eligible Standard regions reach the scorer.

- **Priority:** Highest · **Points:** 8 · **Phase:** P1
- **PRR refs:** §27 Decision tree, §27 HC-1..HC-10
- **Depends on:** ACRME-S0701

Acceptance criteria

- Stage 2 applies HC-1..HC-10 (capacity, quota, zone, separation, freshness, geo, DR floor, Non-Prod/DR integrity, ME cross-geo, extension-path approval).
- Regions failing any HC are excluded from scoring with a recorded reason.
- HC-9 STANDARD_REGION_ONLY and HC-10 CROSS_GEO_EXTENSION_PATH_APPROVED enforced.

Tasks

- ☐ ACRME-T070201 Implement HC-1..HC-8 constraint checks
- ☐ ACRME-T070202 Implement HC-9 and HC-10 constraint checks
- ☐ ACRME-T070203 Record per-region exclusion reasons for audit

ACRME-S0703 — Scenario 1 — geography-based Prod region derivation

As a customer, **I want** to supply an Azure geography and have the engine derive the Prod anchor, **so that** I get the best Standard region in my geography without naming one.

- **Priority:** Highest · **Points:** 8 · **Phase:** P1
- **PRR refs:** §27 Prod input modes, §28 PS_Prod, VR-4
- **Depends on:** ACRME-S0702, ACRME-S0801

Acceptance criteria

- Candidate set = Standard regions in geography minus HC exclusions.
- argmax(PS_Prod); deterministic tie-break by Standard-region list order; cold-start default = first listed.
- Geography-scoped exhaustion error if none eligible (VR-4); never falls outside geography.
- Derived region + all candidate scores + policy version persisted for replay.

Tasks

- ☐ ACRME-T070301 Implement geography candidate-set builder
- ☐ ACRME-T070302 Implement argmax(PS_Prod) selection + deterministic tie-break
- ☐ ACRME-T070303 Implement geography-scoped exhaustion error (VR-4)
- ☐ ACRME-T070304 Persist derivation trace to OperationRecord

ACRME-S0704 — Scenario 2 — specific region input validation

As a customer, I want to name a specific region and have it validated or routed to exception, **so that** a Standard region is used directly and a Restricted region needs approval.

- **Priority:** Highest · **Points:** 5 · **Phase:** P1
- **PRR refs:** §27 Prod input modes
- **Depends on:** ACRME-S0702

Acceptance criteria

- Standard region validated against HC-1..HC-10 then set as Prod anchor; PS_Prod used for post-validation only.
- Restricted region routed to the Exception Deployment Workflow.
- Both modes converge on a fixed, validated Prod anchor.

Tasks

- ☐ ACRME-T070401 Implement Standard-region direct validation path
- ☐ ACRME-T070402 Route Restricted region input to exception workflow

ACRME-S0705 — Sequential CVAL then DR selection from Prod anchor

As a placement engine, I want CVAL and DR selected sequentially from the fixed Prod anchor, **so that** the three-environment layout respects separation and scoring.

- **Priority:** Highest · **Points:** 5 · **Phase:** P1
- **PRR refs:** §27, §28 PS_NonProd/PS_DR
- **Depends on:** ACRME-S0703, ACRME-S0704

Acceptance criteria

- CVAL selected via PS_NonProd (=PS_CVAL); DR via PS_DR from Standard regions.
- Separation constraints honored across the three environments.
- All three environment scores persisted together for replay.

Tasks

- ☐ ACRME-T070501 Implement sequential CVAL selection (PS_NonProd)
- ☐ ACRME-T070502 Implement sequential DR selection (PS_DR)

ACRME-S0706 — Middle East cross-geo extension (Saudi Arabia/UAE North → Belgium Central)

As a placement owner, I want Middle East DR to use the approved Belgium Central extension path, **so that** the three-region minimum is met where only two in-geo regions exist.

- **Priority:** High · **Points:** 5 · **Phase:** P1
- **PRR refs:** §27 Middle East, HC-10, R-12
- **Depends on:** ACRME-S0705

Acceptance criteria

- Prod = argmax(PS_Prod) over Saudi Arabia/UAE North; CVAL = the other in-geo region.
- DR = Belgium Central via the only approved extension path; validated against HC-1..HC-10 incl. DR floor.
- If Belgium Central fails, placement is blocked with an ops alert (no silent substitution).

Tasks

- ☐ ACRME-T070601 Implement Middle East Prod/CVAL in-geo assignment
- ☐ ACRME-T070602 Implement Belgium Central cross-geo DR with HC validation
- ☐ ACRME-T070603 Block + alert on degraded extension path (no substitution)

ACRME-S0707 — Exception-based placement workflow for Restricted regions (EC-1..EC-4)

As a governance owner, **I want** restricted-region use gated behind four exception conditions, **so that** no Restricted region enters production without explicit approval.

- **Priority:** High · **Points:** 5 · **Phase:** P1
- **PRR refs:** §27 Exception workflow, VR-3
- **Depends on:** ACRME-S0704

Acceptance criteria

- EC-1 explicit request, EC-2 Production-only, EC-3 approval record, EC-4 Scenario-2 input all required (VR-3).
- On pass: assign Exception Prod Anchor, mark Exception Deployment, emit capacity-constraint warning.
- CVAL/DR still chosen from Standard regions; exception approval ID mandatory in OperationRecord.

Tasks

- ☐ ACRME-T070701 Implement EC-1..EC-4 gate (VR-3)
- ☐ ACRME-T070702 Implement Exception Deployment marking + warning
- ☐ ACRME-T070703 Require exception approval ID in OperationRecord commit

ACRME-S0708 — Validation Rule Framework (VR-1..VR-11) and governance controls

As a governance owner, **I want** the full validation-rule framework and PlacementPolicy governance enforced, **so that** region-selection changes require approval and are auditable.

- **Priority:** Medium · **Points:** 5 · **Phase:** P1
- **PRR refs:** §27 VR framework, §27 Governance
- **Depends on:** ACRME-S0701

Acceptance criteria

- VR-1..VR-11 implemented with the specified failure actions.
- Classification/extension changes require PlacementPolicy update + governance approval + Decision Log entry.
- Policy version referenced on every placement decision.

Tasks

- ☐ ACRME-T070801 Implement remaining VR-5..VR-11 rules
- ☐ ACRME-T070802 Enforce PlacementPolicy change governance + Decision Log

ACRME-E08 — Placement Scoring & Forecasting

Goal. Implement the corrected, clamped scoring formulas (PS_Prod/PS_NonProd/PS_DR) with demand-weighted distribution, versioned weights, and advisory forecasting.

PRR references. §28, §4 Scoring, R-36, R-37, R-29

Rollup. 4 stories · 23 points

Story	Title	Priority	Points	Phase	Depends on
ACRME-S0801	Corrected, clamped scoring formulas with versioned weights	Highest	8	P1	ACRME-S0103

Story	Title	Priority	Points	Phase	Depends on
ACRME-S0802	Demand-weighted distribution and SKU-dimensional model	High	5	P1	ACRME-S0801
ACRME-S0803	Advisory forecasting with measured accuracy	Medium	5	P2	ACRME-S0801
ACRME-S0804	Shadow joint-optimization comparison	Medium	5	P2	ACRME-S0801

ACRME-S0801 — Corrected, clamped scoring formulas with versioned weights

As a placement owner, **I want** PS_Prod/PS_NonProd/PS_DR with clamped components and versioned weights, **so that** scores are bounded [0,1], replayable, and auditable.

- **Priority:** Highest · **Points:** 8 · **Phase:** P1
- **PRR refs:** §28 Corrected scoring
- **Depends on:** ACRME-S0103

Acceptance criteria

- Each component clamped via $\text{Clamp}(x) = \max(0, \min(1, x))$; score in [0,1].
- Default weights ($\alpha 0.30, \beta 0.20, \gamma 0.25, \delta 0.15, \epsilon 0.10$) retained for pilot comparison; PS_NonProd uses revised weights.
- Weights carry a PolicyVersion; inputs + version persisted per decision.

Tasks

- ☐ ACRME-T080101 Implement PS_Prod/PS_NonProd/PS_DR with clamping
- ☐ ACRME-T080102 Externalise weights into versioned PolicyVersion
- ☐ ACRME-T080103 Persist score inputs + policy version to OperationRecord

ACRME-S0802 — Demand-weighted distribution and SKU-dimensional model

As a placement owner, **I want** distribution computed from demand units and scoring per SKU/zone, **so that** fairness reflects real demand, not customer count.

- **Priority:** High · **Points:** 5 · **Phase:** P1
- **PRR refs:** §28 Distribution, R-36, R-37
- **Depends on:** ACRME-S0801

Acceptance criteria

- $\text{Distribution} = 1 - \text{Region_Assigned_Demand} / \text{Total_Assigned_Demand}$ (R-37).
- Scoring is SKU-dimensional to avoid simple-formula invalidation (R-36).

Tasks

- ☐ ACRME-T080201 Implement demand-weighted distribution signal (R-37)
- ☐ ACRME-T080202 Make scoring SKU/zone-dimensional (R-36)

ACRME-S0803 — Advisory forecasting with measured accuracy

As a capacity planner, **I want** forecast quantity recommendations that stay advisory until accuracy is measured, **so that** forecasts never drive unsafe automatic reduction.

- **Priority:** Medium · **Points:** 5 · **Phase:** P2
- **PRR refs:** §28 Forecast, R-29, ForecastError alert
- **Depends on:** ACRME-S0801

Acceptance criteria

- Forecast_Quantity = $\text{ceil}(\text{Forecast_Peak} \times (1 + \text{Growth_Buffer}) + \text{DR_Buffer})$ with 30/60/90-day horizons.
- Recommendations advisory-only; reduction never automatic (R-29).
- ForecastError alert when error exceeds policy; accuracy/false-positive tracked.

Tasks

- ☐ ACRME-T080301 Implement ForecastRecord entity + forecast formula
- ☐ ACRME-T080302 Keep forecast advisory; wire ForecastError alert (R-29)

ACRME-S0804 — Shadow joint-optimization comparison

As a placement owner, **I want** the sequential method compared against a shadow joint-optimization method, **so that** divergence evidence is gathered before trusting either for auto-commit.

- **Priority:** Medium · **Points:** 5 · **Phase:** P2
- **PRR refs:** §4 Sequential placement, §22 Should
- **Depends on:** ACRME-S0801

Acceptance criteria

- Both methods run without mutating live resources; divergences measured and logged.
- Comparison report available for governance review.

Tasks

- ☐ ACRME-T080401 Implement shadow joint-optimization evaluator
- ☐ ACRME-T080402 Log divergences + produce comparison report

ACRME-E09 — State Model & Concurrency Controls

Goal. Implement the engine state machine (EngineModelState) with conditional transitions and dual approval, and atomic capacity holds to prevent over-assignment. Production blocker G-15 / B-7.

PRR references. §29, G-15, B-3, B-7, R-35

Rollup. 2 stories · 21 points

Story	Title	Priority	Points	Phase	Depends on
ACRME-S0901	Engine state machine with conditional transitions and dual approval (G-15)	Highest	13	P1	ACRME-S0103
ACRME-S0902	Atomic capacity holds with optimistic concurrency (B-7 / G-20)	Highest	8	P1	ACRME-S0103

ACRME-S0901 — Engine state machine with conditional transitions and dual approval (G-15)

As a SRE, I want EngineModeState with guarded transitions, dual approval, and incident hold, **so that** normal and crisis operations can never illegally mix.

- **Priority:** Highest · **Points:** 13 · **Phase:** P1
- **PRR refs:** §29 State machine, G-15, R-35
- **Depends on:** ACRME-S0103

Acceptance criteria

- States STEADY_STATE, DR_DECLARATION_PENDING, DR_EVENT_ACTIVE, FAILBACK_PENDING, INCIDENT_HOLD implemented.
- Transitions use conditional writes + state version; dual approval required to leave STEADY_STATE.
- Fault-injection test shows no illegal transition (closes G-15/R-35); EngineModeConflict alert wired.
- EngineModeState carries scope, mode, version, incident ID, approvers, lease owner/expiry, recovery checkpoint.

Tasks

- ☐ ACRME-T090101 Model EngineModeState entity with all required fields
- ☐ ACRME-T090102 Implement transition guards + conditional writes
- ☐ ACRME-T090103 Implement dual-approval and incident-hold transitions
- ☐ ACRME-T090104 Write fault-injection tests proving no illegal transition
- ☐ ACRME-T090105 Wire EngineModeConflict alert

ACRME-S0902 — Atomic capacity holds with optimistic concurrency (B-7 / G-20)

As a placement engine, I want an atomic hold keyed by region/SKU/zone/env/policy before returning an assignment, **so that** concurrent placements cannot double-assign the same capacity.

- **Priority:** Highest · **Points:** 8 · **Phase:** P1
- **PRR refs:** §29 Capacity holds, B-7, R-23, G-20
- **Depends on:** ACRME-S0103

Acceptance criteria

- PlacementHold created before commit; expires if Azure provisioning does not begin.
- Parallel placement test produces exactly one winner (closes B-7/R-23).
- CustomerRegionAssignment linked to hold IDs (closes G-20); PlacementHoldConflict alert wired.

Tasks

- ☐ ACRME-T090201 Model PlacementHold + CustomerRegionAssignment entities (G-20)
- ☐ ACRME-T090202 Implement optimistic-concurrency hold create/expire
- ☐ ACRME-T090203 Write parallel-placement single-winner test (B-7)
- ☐ ACRME-T090204 Wire PlacementHoldConflict alert

ACRME-E10 — DR Activation & Failback

Goal. Implement guarded DR declaration, per-workload failover orchestration, engine-enforced DR floor with independent detector, and wave-based failback.

PRR references. §31, Runbook E, §5 DR floor, R-07, R-27, R-38

Rollup. 3 stories · 24 points

Story	Title	Priority	Points	Phase	Depends on
ACRME-S1001	DR declaration and failover orchestration	High	8	P2	ACRME-S0901
ACRME-S1002	Engine-enforced DR floor with independent detector	Highest	8	P1	ACRME-S0901
ACRME-S1003	Wave-based fallback with readiness gate	High	8	P2	ACRME-S1001

ACRME-S1001 — DR declaration and failover orchestration

As a DR operator, **I want** a guarded DR declaration that validates state then orchestrates approved failover, **so that** failover only runs in a validated DR_EVENT_ACTIVE mode.

- **Priority:** High · **Points:** 8 · **Phase:** P2
- **PRR refs:** §31, IncidentRecord G-21
- **Depends on:** ACRME-S0901

Acceptance criteria

- Declaration validates approvals + state version before entering DR_EVENT_ACTIVE.
- Quota, CR, and sharing re-validated from authoritative sources at declaration.
- Per-workload failover status tracked; IncidentRecord persisted (closes G-21).
- Declaration alone does not authorize Tier 2/Tier 3.

Tasks

- ☐ ACRME-T100101 Model IncidentRecord + DRCapacityPair entities (G-21)
- ☐ ACRME-T100102 Implement DR declaration validation + mode entry
- ☐ ACRME-T100103 Implement per-workload failover orchestration

ACRME-S1002 — Engine-enforced DR floor with independent detector

As a SRE, **I want** an engine-enforced DR floor plus an independent recalculating detector, **so that** NonProd expansion fails closed when the floor is at risk.

- **Priority:** Highest · **Points:** 8 · **Phase:** P1
- **PRR refs:** §5 DR floor, R-07, R-38, DRFloorViolation alert
- **Depends on:** ACRME-S0901

Acceptance criteria

- Independent detector recomputes the floor from assignments/allocations (R-38).
- Automatic NonProd expansion blocked on detector disagreement (fail-closed, R-07).
- DRFloorViolation alert fires when NonProd use exceeds the effective ceiling.

Tasks

- ☐ ACRME-T100201 Implement primary DR-floor calculation from potential demand
- ☐ ACRME-T100202 Implement independent detector + fail-closed block (R-07)
- ☐ ACRME-T100203 Recompute floor from assignments to avoid staleness (R-38)
- ☐ ACRME-T100204 Wire DRFloorViolation alert

ACRME-S1003 — Wave-based failback with readiness gate

As a DR operator, **I want** failback gated on primary readiness and executed in waves, **so that** failback never starts before the primary is truly ready.

- **Priority:** High · **Points:** 8 · **Phase:** P2
- **PRR refs:** Runbook E, R-27
- **Depends on:** ACRME-S1001

Acceptance criteria

- Readiness gate validates app/data/network/DNS/identity/capacity before failback (R-27).
- Restore in waves with health checks; DR traffic drained only after validation.
- DR floor + reservation policy recalculated; return to STEADY_STATE only after all ops close.

Tasks

- ☐ ACRME-T100301 Implement failback readiness gate + approval (R-27)
- ☐ ACRME-T100302 Implement wave-based restore + health validation
- ☐ ACRME-T100303 Implement conservative DR deallocation + floor recalculation

ACRME-E11 — Tier Escalation (Emergency Capacity)

Goal. Implement the tiered emergency-capacity ladder: Tier 1 additive expansion (gated), Tier 2 quota-neutral transfer (disabled until proven), Tier 3 blocked in Phase 1.

PRR references. §32, Runbook C, Runbook D, R-16, R-17, R-18

Rollup. 3 stories · 19 points

Story	Title	Priority	Points	Phase	Depends on
ACRME-S1101	Tier 1 additive emergency expansion (incident-gated)	High	8	P2	ACRME-S0901, ACRME-S0302
ACRME-S1102	Tier 2 quota-neutral transfer (disabled until proven)	Medium	8	P2	ACRME-S1101, ACRME-S0503
ACRME-S1103	Tier 3 disassociation blocked in Phase 1	Highest	3	P1	ACRME-S0901

ACRME-S1101 — Tier 1 additive emergency expansion (incident-gated)

As a DR operator, **I want** Tier 1 expansion allowed only in DR_EVENT_ACTIVE with fresh checks, **so that** pre-staged headroom is used safely and never outside an incident.

- **Priority:** High · **Points:** 8 · **Phase:** P2
- **PRR refs:** §32, Runbook C, R-16
- **Depends on:** ACRME-S0901, ACRME-S0302

Acceptance criteria

- Tier 1 rejected unless DR_EVENT_ACTIVE (engine-mode guard, R-16).
- Fresh quota/capacity/sharing confirmed; delta bounded by policy maximum.
- CR increase submitted with idempotency key, polled, and read back before VM deployment.

Tasks

- ☐ ACRME-T110101 Implement Tier 1 engine-mode guard (R-16)
- ☐ ACRME-T110102 Implement bounded additive expansion + read-back (Runbook C)

ACRME-S1102 — Tier 2 quota-neutral transfer (disabled until proven)

As a DR operator, **I want** Tier 2 reallocation behind a proven+approved flag with impact preview, **so that** NonProd guarantees are never removed unexpectedly.

- **Priority:** Medium · **Points:** 8 · **Phase:** P2
- **PRR refs:** §32, Runbook D, B-2, R-17
- **Depends on:** ACRME-S1101, ACRME-S0503

Acceptance criteria

- Tier 2 disabled until release-and-reuse behavior is measured (B-2) and enabled by flag.
- Requires incident mode + approval + customer-impact preview (R-17).
- DR expanded only after authoritative quota headroom is visible; timeout escalates manually.
- EmergencyCapacityTransfer entity persisted (G-23) with NonProd assurance impact + restoration plan.

Tasks

- ☐ ACRME-T110201 Model EmergencyCapacityTransfer entity (G-23)
- ☐ ACRME-T110202 Implement Tier 2 flag + release-and-reuse gate (B-2)
- ☐ ACRME-T110203 Implement impact preview + approval + manual timeout (Runbook D)

ACRME-S1103 — Tier 3 disassociation blocked in Phase 1

As a security owner, **I want** Tier 3 calls rejected while disabled, **so that** no VM association change happens before the credential model is closed.

- **Priority:** Highest · **Points:** 3 · **Phase:** P1
- **PRR refs:** §32, R-18, Tier3AttemptBlocked alert
- **Depends on:** ACRME-S0901

Acceptance criteria

- Tier 3 request rejected while disabled; Tier3AttemptBlocked alert fires (R-18).
- Feature is disabled-by-default and requires separate board authorization to enable.

Tasks

- ☐ ACRME-T110301 Implement Tier 3 disabled-by-default rejection
- ☐ ACRME-T110302 Wire Tier3AttemptBlocked alert (R-18)

ACRME-E12 — AKS & VMSS Integration

Goal. Validate AKS node-pool/autoscaler integration with CRGs and enforce VMSS controls, including rejecting VMSS in emergency transfers (Preview limit).

PRR references. §33, §6 AKS/VMSS, FC-08, R-20, R-21, R-22, R-42

Rollup. 2 stories · 13 points

Story	Title	Priority	Points	Phase	Depends on
ACRME-S1201	AKS node-pool and autoscaler validation	Medium	8	P2	ACRME-S0502, ACRME-S0602

Story	Title	Priority	Points	Phase	Depends on
ACRME-S1202	VMSS controls and emergency-transfer rejection (FC-08)	High	5	P1	ACRME-S1103

ACRME-S1201 — AKS node-pool and autoscaler validation

As a AKS owner, **I want** new node pools validated against zone/SKU/sharing/quota and bounded autoscaler, **so that** AKS never repeatedly requests unavailable nodes or exceeds reservation.

- **Priority:** Medium · **Points:** 8 · **Phase:** P2
- **PRR refs:** §33 AKS, R-21, R-22
- **Depends on:** ACRME-S0502, ACRME-S0602

Acceptance criteria

- New node pool references a CRG only after zone/SKU/sharing/provider+consumer quota checks.
- Autoscaler max bounded by validated reservation + policy over-allocation; retries bounded (R-21).
- Existing node-pool change requires a replacement-impact plan (R-22); node identity separate from ACRME identity.

Tasks

- ☐ ACRME-T120101 Implement AKS node-pool pre-validation checks
- ☐ ACRME-T120102 Enforce bounded autoscaler max + bounded retries (R-21)
- ☐ ACRME-T120103 Require replacement-impact plan for pool updates (R-22)

ACRME-S1202 — VMSS controls and emergency-transfer rejection (FC-08)

As a compute owner, **I want** VMSS operations gated and VMSS excluded from emergency transfers, **so that** a Preview reprovisioning limitation cannot cause a failed DR.

- **Priority:** High · **Points:** 5 · **Phase:** P1
- **PRR refs:** §33 VMSS, FC-08, R-20, R-42, VMSSEmergencyAttempt alert
- **Depends on:** ACRME-S1103

Acceptance criteria

- VMSS included in an emergency transfer is rejected; VMSSEmergencyAttempt alert fires (R-20).
- VMSS reprovisioning via shared CRG during a zone outage documented as Preview-limited (FC-08/R-42).
- Uniform/Flexible create-with-CRG allowed only after mode-specific POC proof.

Tasks

- ☐ ACRME-T120201 Implement VMSS emergency-transfer rejection + alert (R-20)
- ☐ ACRME-T120202 Encode VMSS Uniform/Flexible control matrix (Phase 1 gating)

ACRME-E13 — Data Architecture & Entity Model

Goal. Establish the canonical authoritative entity model and close data-model gaps (G-20, G-21, G-23, G-24) with schema, audit, and policy versioning.

PRR references. §34, G-20, G-21, G-23, G-24

Rollup. 2 stories · 13 points

Story	Title	Priority	Points	Phase	Depends on
ACRME-S1301	Canonical authoritative entity schema and policy versioning	High	8	P1	ACRME-S0103
ACRME-S1302	Append-only audit model with completeness guarantee	High	5	P1	ACRME-S1301

ACRME-S1301 — Canonical authoritative entity schema and policy versioning

As a data owner, **I want** all authoritative entities modeled with a shared schema and PolicyVersion, **so that** engine intent is consistent, versioned, and replayable.

- **Priority:** High · **Points:** 8 · **Phase:** P1
- **PRR refs:** §34 Authoritative entities
- **Depends on:** ACRME-S0103

Acceptance criteria

- All §34 entities have a canonical schema with IDs, timestamps, and version fields.
- PolicyVersion referenced by placement, scoring, and quota decisions.
- Schema migrations are versioned and reversible.

Tasks

- ☐ ACRME-T130101 Author canonical schema for all authoritative entities
- ☐ ACRME-T130102 Implement PolicyVersion entity + references
- ☐ ACRME-T130103 Set up versioned, reversible migrations

ACRME-S1302 — Append-only audit model with completeness guarantee

As a compliance owner, **I want** every accepted mutation to produce an append-only audit record, **so that** incidents and decisions can always be reconstructed.

- **Priority:** High · **Points:** 5 · **Phase:** P1
- **PRR refs:** §34, R-31, §37 Audit completeness SLI
- **Depends on:** ACRME-S1301

Acceptance criteria

- Append-only audit for 100% of accepted mutations (audit completeness SLI, R-31).
- OperationRecord captures before/after state, policy version, and evidence classification.
- Audit is immutable and independently queryable.

Tasks

- ☐ ACRME-T130201 Implement append-only OperationRecord/audit store
- ☐ ACRME-T130202 Instrument all mutations to emit audit records (R-31)

ACRME-E14 — API Architecture

Goal. Deliver the canonical async API: operation-resource responses, mandatory mutation meta-data, dry-run for high-impact ops, and disabled-by-default emergency endpoints.

PRR references. §35, G-23, R-34

Rollup. 3 stories · 16 points

Story	Title	Priority	Points	Phase	Depends on
ACRME-S1401	Core async endpoints returning operation resources	Highest	8	P1	ACRME-S0101
ACRME-S1402	Mandatory mutation metadata and dry-run	High	5	P1	ACRME-S1401
ACRME-S1403	Emergency endpoints disabled-by-default with contract tests (G-23)	Medium	3	P1	ACRME-S1401

ACRME-S1401 — Core async endpoints returning operation resources

As a API consumer, **I want** state-changing endpoints to return an operation resource, not synchronous completion, **so that** callers poll for true Azure state instead of assuming completion.

- **Priority:** Highest · **Points:** 8 · **Phase:** P1
- **PRR refs:** §35 Core endpoints
- **Depends on:** ACRME-S0101

Acceptance criteria

- All §35 core endpoints implemented; mutations return an operation + polling URL.
- /placement/select-regions accepts either a specific region (Scenario 2) or a geography (Scenario 1).
- /operations/{id} returns current operation state.

Tasks

- ☐ ACRME-T140101 Implement core resource endpoints (subscriptions/crgs/quota/...)
- ☐ ACRME-T140102 Implement /placement/select-regions dual-input contract
- ☐ ACRME-T140103 Implement /operations/{id} polling resource

ACRME-S1402 — Mandatory mutation metadata and dry-run

As a API consumer, **I want** every mutation to require idempotency key, expected version, policy version, and support dry-run, **so that** high-impact operations are safe, idempotent, and previewable.

- **Priority:** High · **Points:** 5 · **Phase:** P1
- **PRR refs:** §35 Every mutation
- **Depends on:** ACRME-S1401

Acceptance criteria

- Mutations require idempotency key, caller identity, expected state version, policy version, incident ID where applicable.
- Dry-run supported for high-impact operations; structured precondition failures returned.

Tasks

- ❑ ACRME-T140201 Enforce mandatory mutation metadata middleware
- ❑ ACRME-T140202 Implement dry-run + structured precondition failures

ACRME-S1403 — Emergency endpoints disabled-by-default with contract tests (G-23)

As a governance owner, **I want** emergency-transfer/increase endpoints in the canonical API but disabled by default, **so that** they exist in the contract and audit model before being enabled.

- **Priority:** Medium · **Points:** 3 · **Phase:** P1
- **PRR refs:** §35, G-23, G-24
- **Depends on:** ACRME-S1401

Acceptance criteria

- /capacity/emergency-transfer and /capacity/increase-requests in the canonical API + authorization matrix.
- Emergency endpoint disabled-by-default via feature flag; contract test present (G-23).

Tasks

- ❑ ACRME-T140301 Add emergency + increase endpoints to contract + authz matrix
- ❑ ACRME-T140302 Flag-gate emergency endpoint + add contract test (G-23)

ACRME-E15 — Security, RBAC & Managed Identity

Goal. Implement split UAMIs and application roles with least privilege, and close G-14 (customer-consented, RG-scoped Tier 3 credential model) or keep Tier 3 blocked.

PRR references. §36, §11, G-14, R-19, R-32

Rollup. 3 stories · 19 points

Story	Title	Priority	Points	Phase	Depends on
ACRME-S1501	Split UAMIs and application roles (least privilege)	Highest	8	P1	ACRME-S0105
ACRME-S1502	G-14 credential model for Tier 3 (customer-consented, RG-scoped)	Highest	8	P2	ACRME-S1501
ACRME-S1503	Break-glass control with time-bound access and post-review	Medium	3	P1	ACRME-S1501

ACRME-S1501 — Split UAMIs and application roles (least privilege)

As a security owner, **I want** the RBAC matrix realized as narrow custom roles and separated identities, **so that** privilege is never concentrated and duties are separated.

- **Priority:** Highest · **Points:** 8 · **Phase:** P1
- **PRR refs:** §36 RBAC matrix, R-19
- **Depends on:** ACRME-S0105

Acceptance criteria

- Reader/Capacity/Sharing/Consumer-Compute/Quota UAMIs + DR/Emergency/Policy-Admin/Auditor roles created per matrix.
- Each role scoped narrowly; prohibited actions verified blocked in a least-privilege test (R-19).
- Role-assignment authority isolated from capacity/VM mutation.

Tasks

- ☐ ACRME-T150101 Deploy custom role definitions per RBAC matrix
- ☐ ACRME-T150102 Assign UAMIs at narrowest scope + application roles
- ☐ ACRME-T150103 Write least-privilege prohibited-action tests (R-19)

ACRME-S1502 — G-14 credential model for Tier 3 (customer-consented, RG-scoped)

As a security owner, **I want** a customer-consented UAMI with RG-scoped custom rights for exact VM association ops, **so that** Tier 3 can eventually be enabled without subscription-wide VM Contributor.

- **Priority:** Highest · **Points:** 8 · **Phase:** P2
- **PRR refs:** §36 MI scope, G-14
- **Depends on:** ACRME-S1501

Acceptance criteria

- Minimum custom action set for VM association defined + RG-scoped; no subscription-wide VM Contributor.
- Customer consent + revocation path implemented and tested in a consumer subscription (closes G-14).
- If the minimum action set cannot be established, Tier 3 stays blocked.

Tasks

- ☐ ACRME-T150201 Define minimum custom VM-association action set (G-14)
- ☐ ACRME-T150202 Implement customer consent + revocation flow
- ☐ ACRME-T150203 Test least-privilege + revocation in consumer subscription

ACRME-S1503 — Break-glass control with time-bound access and post-review

As a security owner, **I want** break-glass access to be time-bound, alerted, and post-reviewed, **so that** emergency bypass cannot be silently abused.

- **Priority:** Medium · **Points:** 3 · **Phase:** P1
- **PRR refs:** §11, R-32
- **Depends on:** ACRME-S1501

Acceptance criteria

- Break-glass role is time-bound and auto-expires; activation raises an alert (R-32).
- Mandatory post-use review recorded in audit.

Tasks

- ☐ ACRME-T150301 Implement time-bound break-glass role + auto-expiry
- ☐ ACRME-T150302 Wire activation alert + post-review record (R-32)

ACRME-E16 — Observability, Dashboards & Alerts

Goal. Deliver SLI/SLO instrumentation, operational dashboards, and the full critical alert catalog so operators can see floor integrity, drift, and blocks.

PRR references. §37

Rollup. 3 stories · 15 points

Story	Title	Priority	Points	Phase	Depends on
ACRME-S1601	SLI/SLO instrumentation	High	5	P1	ACRME-S0101
ACRME-S1602	Operational dashboards	High	5	P1	ACRME-S1601
ACRME-S1603	Critical alert catalog	Highest	5	P1	ACRME-S1601

ACRME-S1601 — SLI/SLO instrumentation

As a SRE, I want the proposed SLIs measured against SLO targets, **so that** engine health is observable and reportable.

- **Priority:** High · **Points:** 5 · **Phase:** P1
- **PRR refs:** §37 SLI/SLO
- **Depends on:** ACRME-S0101

Acceptance criteria

- Query success, mutation availability, placement latency, reconciliation age, and audit completeness measured.
- SLO targets configured with breach reporting; labeled internal (not Microsoft guarantees).

Tasks

- ☐ ACRME-T160101 Instrument SLI metrics + emit to monitoring
- ☐ ACRME-T160102 Configure SLO targets + breach reporting

ACRME-S1602 — Operational dashboards

As a operator, I want dashboards for capacity, quota, DR floor, sharing, placement, engine mode, and failures, **so that** state is visible at a glance during steady state and incidents.

- **Priority:** High · **Points:** 5 · **Phase:** P1
- **PRR refs:** §37 Dashboards
- **Depends on:** ACRME-S1601

Acceptance criteria

- Dashboards cover capacity, quota headroom, DR floor integrity, sharing, placement decisions, engine mode, failed ops.
- Dashboards render from live snapshots + engine state.

Tasks

- ☐ ACRME-T160201 Build capacity/quota/DR-floor dashboards
- ☐ ACRME-T160202 Build sharing/placement/engine-mode/failed-ops dashboards

ACRME-S1603 — Critical alert catalog

As a SRE, I want the full alert catalog wired with severities and triggers, **so that** critical guardrail violations page the right responders.

- **Priority:** Highest · **Points:** 5 · **Phase:** P1
- **PRR refs:** §37 Alert catalog
- **Depends on:** ACRME-S1601

Acceptance criteria

- All catalog alerts implemented with correct severity + trigger (Engine/DRFloor/Unauthorized/Tier3/VMSS)
- Critical alerts route to on-call; alert tests validate firing conditions.

Tasks

- ☐ ACRME-T160301 Implement Critical alerts (EngineModeConflict, DRFloorViolation, ...)
- ☐ ACRME-T160302 Implement High/Medium/Low alerts + routing + tests

ACRME-E17 — Reconciliation & Scaling

Goal. Adaptive, delta-based reconciliation that stays within API budgets at hundreds-thousands of customers, with drift handling and throttle resilience.

PRR references. §10, §7, R-04, R-24, R-25, R-40, FC-16

Rollup. 4 stories · 23 points

Story	Title	Priority	Points	Phase	Depends on
ACRME-S1701	Adaptive delta-based reconciliation within API budgets	High	8	P1	ACRME-S0103
ACRME-S1702	ARM throttling resilience with per-service budgets	High	5	P1	ACRME-S0104
ACRME-S1703	Drift handling and maintenance mode	Medium	5	P1	ACRME-S1701
ACRME-S1704	Capacity-exhaustion queue and handling	Medium	5	P2	ACRME-S0701

ACRME-S1701 — Adaptive delta-based reconciliation within API budgets

As a SRE, I want targeted, event-triggered reconciliation instead of naive full scans, **so that** reconciliation stays within API budgets at scale.

- **Priority:** High · **Points:** 8 · **Phase:** P1
- **PRR refs:** §10 Adaptive reconciliation, R-24
- **Depends on:** ACRME-S0103

Acceptance criteria

- Reconciliation is delta/event-triggered; full-estate short-interval scan is not used (R-24).
- Critical targeted reconciliation P95 < 2 min; stable-resource age P95 < 15 min.
- ReconciliationStale alert on age beyond policy; ARM confirmation before mutation (R-04).

Tasks

- ☐ ACRME-T170101 Implement adaptive/delta reconciliation scheduler
- ☐ ACRME-T170102 Implement event-triggered targeted refresh
- ☐ ACRME-T170103 Wire ReconciliationStale + ARGDiscoveryLag alerts

ACRME-S1702 — ARM throttling resilience with per-service budgets

As a SRE, I want per-service API budgets, adaptive backoff, and a manual path, **so that** throttling never blocks DR actions.

- **Priority:** High · **Points:** 5 · **Phase:** P1

- **PRR refs:** §7 FC-16, R-25, ARMThrottling alert
- **Depends on:** ACRME-S0104

Acceptance criteria

- Per-service budgets + adaptive backoff seeded from documented throttle baselines (FC-16).
- ARMThrottling alert on retry-budget/throttle-ratio breach; documented manual path independent of engine (R-25).

Tasks

- ☐ ACRME-T170201 Implement per-service rate budgets + adaptive backoff (FC-16)
- ☐ ACRME-T170202 Wire ARMThrottling alert + manual fallback runbook (R-25)

ACRME-S1703 — Drift handling and maintenance mode

As a operations engineer, **I want** maintenance mode and a clear drift policy, **so that** manual Azure changes are not unexpectedly reverted.

- **Priority:** Medium · **Points:** 5 · **Phase:** P1
- **PRR refs:** §10, R-40
- **Depends on:** ACRME-S1701

Acceptance criteria

- Maintenance mode suppresses reconciliation-driven reversal; drift policy documented (R-40).
- Drift surfaced with a clear reconcile-or-accept decision.

Tasks

- ☐ ACRME-T170301 Implement maintenance mode + drift policy (R-40)
- ☐ ACRME-T170302 Implement drift surfacing + operator decision path

ACRME-S1704 — Capacity-exhaustion queue and handling

As a operator, **I want** a capacity-exhaustion queue with incident creation and re-evaluation on confirmed state, **so that** exhaustion is handled deterministically, not by elapsed time.

- **Priority:** Medium · **Points:** 5 · **Phase:** P2
- **PRR refs:** Runbook A, §22 Should, CapacityExhausted alert
- **Depends on:** ACRME-S0701

Acceptance criteria

- On no eligible region/CR: freeze holds, rank alternatives without committing, queue + create incident (Runbook A).
- Re-evaluate only after confirmed state change; CapacityExhausted alert fires.

Tasks

- ☐ ACRME-T170401 Implement capacity-exhaustion queue + incident creation
- ☐ ACRME-T170402 Implement confirmed-state re-evaluation + alert (Runbook A)

ACRME-E18 — POC & Validation Program

Goal. Execute the critical POC sequence and record structured evidence so preview behaviors and unknowns are proven before production, not asserted.

PRR references. §42, B-1..B-7, all FC items

Rollup. 4 stories · 29 points

Story	Title	Priority	Points	Phase	Depends on
ACRME-S1801	POC harness with structured evidence capture	High	8	P1	ACRME-S0104
ACRME-S1802	Sharing, quota, and zone-alignment POCs (critical sequence 1-8, incl. 6a)	High	8	P1	ACRME-S1801
ACRME-S1803	DR, concurrency, engine-mode, and tier POCs (critical sequence 9-15)	High	8	P2	ACRME-S1802, ACRME-S0901, ACRME-S0902
ACRME-S1804	VMSS, AKS, and scale POCs (critical sequence 16-18)	Medium	5	P2	ACRME-S1803

ACRME-S1801 — POC harness with structured evidence capture

As a validation engineer, **I want** a POC harness that records API version, region, SKU, zone, IDs, timings, and evidence class, **so that** every result is production-grade evidence, not an assumption.

- **Priority:** High · **Points:** 8 · **Phase:** P1
- **PRR refs:** §42 evidence fields
- **Depends on:** ACRME-S0104

Acceptance criteria

- Harness captures all required evidence fields per run with before/after state + retry history.
- Each result classified as documented/observed/assumed/judgement.

Tasks

- ☐ ACRME-T180101 Build POC harness + structured evidence store
- ☐ ACRME-T180102 Implement evidence classification + report export

ACRME-S1802 — Sharing, quota, and zone-alignment POCs (critical sequence 1-8, incl. 6a)

As a validation engineer, **I want** sharing/RBAC, unsharing, quota independence, quantity, and zone-alignment POCs executed, **so that** foundational platform behaviors are proven before pilot.

- **Priority:** High · **Points:** 8 · **Phase:** P1
- **PRR refs:** §42 seq 1-8, B-1, B-2, B-5, FC-06
- **Depends on:** ACRME-S1801

Acceptance criteria

- Sharing/RBAC, unauthorized-consumer rejection, safe+forced unsharing validated.
- Provider/consumer/group quota independence + quantity/reduction/zero-size behavior validated (B-1/B-5).
- Cross-subscription zone alignment (6a) validated with physical-to-logical tables for ≥ 2 subscriptions.

Tasks

- ☐ ACRME-T180201 Execute POC 1-3 (sharing/RBAC, rejection, unsharing)
- ☐ ACRME-T180202 Execute POC 4-5,7-8 (quota + quantity, group availability B-1)
- ☐ ACRME-T180203 Execute POC 6/6a (zone mapping + cross-sub alignment, FC-06)

ACRME-S1803 — DR, concurrency, engine-mode, and tier POCs (critical sequence 9-15)

As a validation engineer, **I want** DR-floor, concurrency, engine-mode, and Tier 1/2/3 POCs executed, **so that** safety-critical behaviors are proven before enabling automation.

- **Priority:** High · **Points:** 8 · **Phase:** P2
- **PRR refs:** §42 seq 9-15, B-7, B-3
- **Depends on:** ACRME-S1802, ACRME-S0901, ACRME-S0902

Acceptance criteria

- DR-floor enforcement, concurrent placement single-winner (B-7), and engine-mode transitions (B-3) validated.
- Tier 1 + Tier 2 validated; Tier 3 confirmed to remain disabled.

Tasks

- ☐ ACRME-T180301 Execute POC 9-12 (DR floor, quota propagation, concurrency, engine mode)
- ☐ ACRME-T180302 Execute POC 13-15 (Tier 1, Tier 2, Tier 3-disabled)

ACRME-S1804 — VMSS, AKS, and scale POCs (critical sequence 16-18)

As a validation engineer, **I want** VMSS/AKS behavior and scale testing executed, **so that** workload integration and scale limits are measured, not assumed.

- **Priority:** Medium · **Points:** 5 · **Phase:** P2
- **PRR refs:** §42 seq 16-18, FC-08, R-33
- **Depends on:** ACRME-S1803

Acceptance criteria

- VMSS Uniform/Flexible + AKS node-pool/autoscaler behavior validated (or Preview limits documented).
- Scale testing at target cardinality validates reconciliation + throughput budgets.

Tasks

- ☐ ACRME-T180401 Execute POC 16-17 (VMSS Uniform/Flexible, AKS)
- ☐ ACRME-T180402 Execute POC 18 (scale testing) + record budgets

ACRME-E19 — Production Readiness Gates & Governance

Goal. Track gap-closure evidence, preview feature-flag governance, and the production entry gates so pilot→production transitions are evidence-based.

PRR references. §14, §16, §17, §39, §44, R-01, R-34

Rollup. 3 stories · 13 points

Story	Title	Priority	Points	Phase	Depends on
ACRME-S1901	Preview feature-flag governance and exit paths	Highest	5	P1	ACRME-S0104
ACRME-S1902	Gap-closure evidence tracker (G-14/G-15/G-20/G-21/G-23/G-24, B-1..B-7)	High	5	P1	—
ACRME-S1903	Production entry gates and conditional pilot checklist	High	3	P1	ACRME-S1902

ACRME-S1901 — Preview feature-flag governance and exit paths

As a product owner, **I want** every preview dependency behind a flag with a governance acceptance + exit path, **so that** preview changes never silently break production.

- **Priority:** Highest · **Points:** 5 · **Phase:** P1
- **PRR refs:** §21, R-01, R-34, R-42, R-43
- **Depends on:** ACRME-S0104

Acceptance criteria

- CRG sharing, groupType enforcement, and VMSS reprovisioning gated behind feature flags (R-01/R-43/R-42).
- Each flag has recorded governance acceptance + a documented exit path.
- Preview/POC results are evidence-labeled and never presented as an SLA (R-34).

Tasks

- ☐ ACRME-T190101 Implement preview feature-flag framework + registry
- ☐ ACRME-T190102 Record governance acceptance + exit paths per flag
- ☐ ACRME-T190103 Enforce evidence-labeling standard (R-34)

ACRME-S1902 — Gap-closure evidence tracker (G-14/G-15/G-20/G-21/G-23/G-24, B-1..B-7)

As a program owner, **I want** a live tracker mapping each gap to its closure control and acceptance evidence, **so that** production gates are provably met, not assumed.

- **Priority:** High · **Points:** 5 · **Phase:** P1
- **PRR refs:** §39 Gap closure
- **Depends on:** —

Acceptance criteria

- Every gap/blocker has closure control + acceptance evidence status tracked.
- Tracker blocks phase advancement until required evidence is attached.

Tasks

- ☐ ACRME-T190201 Build gap-closure tracker mapping gaps->evidence
- ☐ ACRME-T190202 Gate phase advancement on evidence completeness

ACRME-S1903 — Production entry gates and conditional pilot checklist

As a council/board, **I want** the pilot and production entry gates encoded as an auditable checklist, **so that** pilot success is not mistaken for production approval.

- **Priority:** High · **Points:** 3 · **Phase:** P1
- **PRR refs:** §16, §17, §44 Board actions
- **Depends on:** ACRME-S1902

Acceptance criteria

- Pilot-entry and production-entry gate checklists encoded with named approvers.
- Manual rollback demonstrated; separate production authorization required after pilot.
- Destructive-automation enablement requires separate board authorization.

Tasks

- ☐ ACRME-T190301 Encode pilot + production entry-gate checklists
- ☐ ACRME-T190302 Record named approvers + separate-authorization rule